Dear Quillstone Payments Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Machine Learning Engineer – Customer Support AI role. As a data scientist with over four years of experience in a subscription business, I have built forecasting and customer models and delivered scheduled scoring workflows. I am now moving from data science toward machine learning engineering, bringing experience building and operating scheduled ML workflows, and I am motivated to apply that foundation to practical AI tools that help merchants and support teams.

At Thistlebox, I engineered calendar, price and menu-position features for a LightGBM demand-forecasting model and delivered a scheduled batch scoring workflow in Vertex AI Workbench that writes predictions to BigQuery for operational use. It runs as a scheduled Vertex AI Workbench notebook, writing results to BigQuery for operations teams. The model reduced forecast error from 23% to 14% and food waste by an estimated 9%. I have also added pytest unit tests for its feature code and built an XGBoost churn model scored weekly in BigQuery.

Alongside modelling, I write production SQL, maintain dbt data models, use dbt Cloud scheduling for recurring data workflows and scheduled notebook jobs for scoring, and work with product and growth colleagues on experimentation. I built a Python and Streamlit testing calculator used by approximately 25 colleagues and wrote its Dockerfile; our data platform team handles its deployment. Presenting results to leadership and delivering internal statistics training have helped me communicate technical work to different audiences.

My work with product and growth teams, leadership presentations, and internal Stats for PMs training has taught me to share context clearly, work collaboratively, and turn technical results into practical decisions.

My MSc in Statistics gave me a strong foundation in modelling and evaluation. I would be glad to bring that background, my Python experience and hands-on use of GCP services including BigQuery and Vertex AI Workbench, and a practical approach to Quillstone's collaborative AI team. Thank you for considering my application; I would welcome the chance to discuss the role with you.

Kind regards,
Tobias Mwangi-Hartley